

11 Prime numbers

ANY WHOLE NUMBER LARGER THAN 1 THAT CANNOT BE DIVIDED BY ANY OTHER NUMBER EXCEPT FOR ITSELF AND 1.

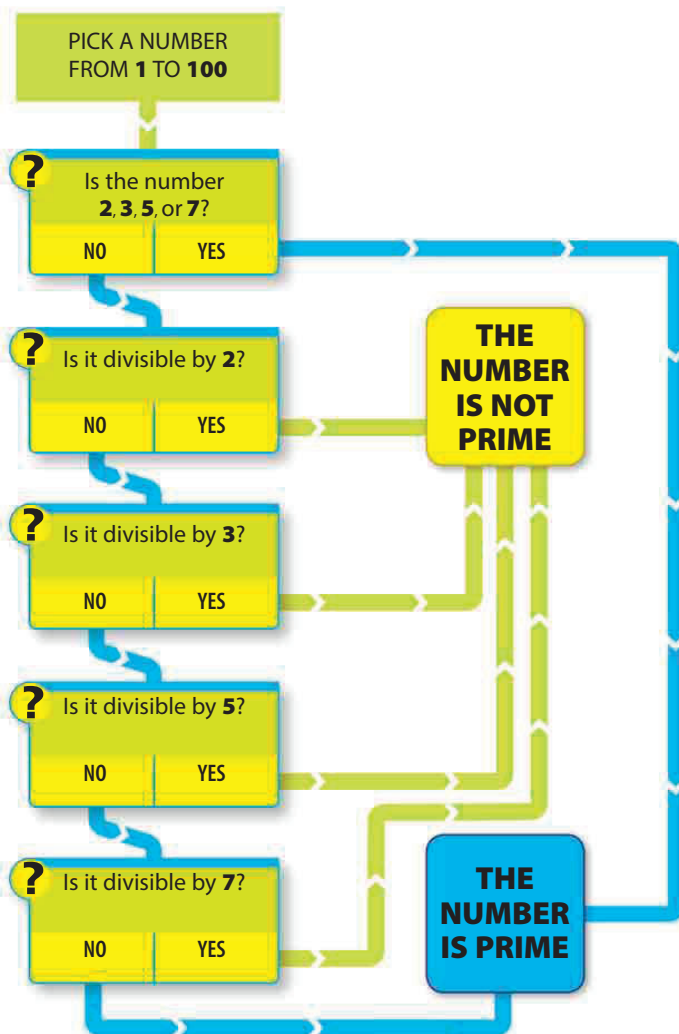
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Introducing prime numbers

Over 2,000 years ago, the Ancient Greek mathematician Euclid noted that some numbers are only divisible by 1 or the number itself. These numbers are known as prime numbers. A number that is not a prime is called a composite—it can be arrived at, or composed, by multiplying together smaller prime numbers, which are known as its prime factors.



△ Is a number prime?

This flowchart can be used to determine whether a number between 1 and 100 is prime by checking if it is divisible by any of the primes 2, 3, 5, and 7.

▷ First 100 numbers

This table shows the prime numbers among the first 100 whole numbers.

1 is not a prime number or a composite number

2 is the only even prime number. No other even number is prime because they are all divisible by 2

1	2	3	4 2	5
11	12 2 3	13	14 2 7	15 3 5
21 3 7	22 2	23	24 2 3	25 5
31	32 2	33 3	34 2	35 5 7
41	42 2 3 7	43	44 2	45 3 5
51 3	52 2	53	54 2 3	55 5
61	62 2	63 3 7	64 2	65 5
71	72 2 3	73	74 2	75 3 5
81 3	82 2	83	84 2 3 7	85 5
91 7	92 2	93 3	94 2	95 5